

Greece

Ratio: 2:3 **Adopted:** 1822 **Usage:** National and Civil

The cross in the canton represents Greek religious faith

Blue represents the sea and sky



White reflects the purity of the Greek independence struggle

The nine stripes represent the nine syllables in the cry "Freedom or Death," uttered during the Greek war of independence

Europe



Once part of the Ottoman Empire, **Greece** has seen periodic unrest since World War II. In 1974 it became a multiparty democracy.

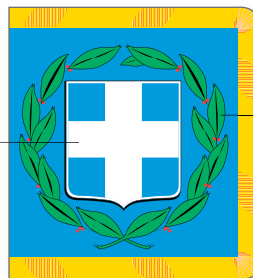
The flag flown by Greece is in the same colors as the one which was raised following independence from the Ottoman Empire in the early 19th century. At times Greece has used a plain white cross on blue as its land flag, and the striped flag at sea. Today the plain Cross Flag is

preserved in the President's flag and in the canton of the blue and white striped national flag.

The shade of blue of the flag has also varied. Today it is the original light blue color of 1822. It was altered in the 1970s and the blue was changed to a much darker, navy shade.

THE PRESIDENT'S FLAG

The original white cross on a blue field is retained in the President's flag and the national arms



The Cross Flag is surrounded by a wreath of laurels